68% of millionaires with a college degree never took out student loans.

Speaking of student loans, I cannot stress this point loudly enough: stay away from them! Don't be fooled by the marketing, either. Sallie Mae and Navient aren't in the *education* business; they're in the *debt* business. That tuition money isn't free. It comes with a price tag that will wreck your life for decades. Getting out of college with $40,000, $60,000, or—heaven forbid—$200,000 in student loan debt will negatively impact your ability to build wealth throughout your life. Because of the power of compound interest, your first decade out of school will be critical to your long-term investing. Sending all your hard-earned money off to pay for student loans will rob you of your wealth-building potential for years. Millionaire-minded people know this. In fact, 68% of the millionaires with a college degree we studied never took out a penny in student loans, compared to 49% of the general population. They understand that wealth building is a long-term job, and they don't want to waste any time with student loan payments. They'd rather do whatever it takes to get out of school debt-free. That way, they can actually *keep* the money they make early in their careers.

Now, I know college costs have gone up significantly in the last ten to fifteen years, but that's still no reason to take on student loan debt. Get creative with scholarships, community college classes, and working while also going through school, because taking out student loans to pay for school has a huge long-term impact. Let's do the math. The average monthly student loan payment for someone in their twenties is $351.[15] If that student avoided student loans, started his or her career without that payment, and invested that $351 into a mutual fund every month instead, they'd have almost $3 million by age 65.[16] Don't miss that. We live in a